Garden Escape

A solo oozeventure
by @van__ho

You wake on a kale. Its leaves are ragged — nibbled to the spine. You've feasted well.
But now the sun is rising. A distant thump. A shadow moves. The human is stomping through the garden.
You hear a spray hiss. A shadow passes overhead.
Today, you must ooze for your life.

You stretch and feel the crunch of trampled dirt. Far off, a scream — one of your friends?
(Roll 1d4 till you reach end of page)

1. A muddy worm warns you: "The salt is coming." You nod. He dives underground. +1 to your next roll.
2. A bitter leaf gives you a stomach churn. Lose 1 stamina.
3. A fallen acorn cap fits snug over your shell. Gain d6 item: Acorn Cap Helmet (Negate 1 hit).
4. A mist of repellent drifts in. You duck too late. Lose 2 health.
5. A crack opens beneath you. Roll d6:
- 5–6: You leap across!
- 1–4: You tumble and bruise. Lose 2 stamina.

6. An ant scurries by holding a broken candy bead. You lick the trail. It burns. Lose 1 health, gain +1 to next roll.
7. A pile of broken shells — old snail friends. You pause, shell heavy. Lose 1 stamina.

The Salt Patch

The soil here is pale. Crusty flecks sparkle in the sun. Your slime starts to sting.
(Roll 1d4 till you reach end of page)

1. A clump of salt lands near your tail. Roll d6:
- 4–6: You pull free in time.
- 1–3: It burns. Lose 4 health.

2. You pass a dried-out slug curled like paper. Its eyes stare up. You press on. Gain +1 to next roll.
3. The human spots you! A boot crashes down. Roll d6:
- 5–6: You dive into a crack.
- 1–4: You're clipped. Lose 3 health.

4. A soggy leaf curls just right — like a little shield. You tuck it close. Gain d8 item: Leaf Shield — block the next salt splash.
5. A flick of white dust rains from above — the human's shaking a pouch. You panic-slide into a crack. Roll d6:
- 5–6: Safe... just barely.
- 1–4: Too slow. Lose 2 stamina.

The Vinegar Puddle

You smell it before you see it. Sharp. Sour. Wrong. A puddle glistens — rainbowed with oil and vinegar. Bugs twitch along the rim.
(Roll 1d4 till you reach end of page)

1. You misjudge the edge — splash!
Roll d6:
- 4–6: You skim across and shake it off.
- 1–3: It sears your belly. Lose 3 health.

2. A beetle floats on its back, legs waving. You nudge it free. It nods and scuttles off. +1 to next roll.
3. A candy wrapper flaps in the wind. You cling on as it sails you across the puddle. Skip next stamina loss.
4. A vinegar droplet splashes your shell — you hiss. But beneath the pain, you spot a glinting scale. Gain d6 item: Shiny Bug Scale — reroll once.
5. A centipede skitters past in panic. You follow its trail through safe muck. +1 to next roll.

The Birds

Above, leaves rustle. Shadows sweep. A chirp — sharp and cruel. The birds are hunting.
(Roll 1d4 to see what you encounter.)

1. A beak stabs down beside you! Roll d6:
- 5–6: You tuck under a root.
- 1–4: It grazes you. Lose 5 health.

2. A feather flutters down, dappled and soft. You press it to your back — camouflage! Avoid next bird encounter.
3. A friend! A spider lowers on silk, eyes wide. "I'll distract them." It vanishes into the leaves. +1 to next roll.
4. Bird droppings splatter nearby. You recoil — it reeks. But inside it: seeds! Gain item: Sticky Seed Pod — throw before a roll to lower enemy result by -1. One use.

The trees thin.
Something metallic glints beyond the weeds...

The Human Returns

A tremor. The thud of a boot. He's back — stomping, spraying, scattering salt like snow. Your slime trail has been found.
(Roll 1d4 to see what happens next.)

1. A salt shaker rains down beside you. Roll d6:
- 5–6: You dive under a dandelion leaf.
- 1–4: You're sprinkled. Lose 6 health.

2. The human scoops up a beetle. You freeze — he doesn't see you. +1 to next roll.
3. A dropped spoon glints in the grass. You slide up the handle — it catapults you forward!
4. A shadow passes overhead — he's looking right at you. You freeze beside a stone. Roll d6:
- 5–6: He moves on.
- 1–4: A boot lands nearby. Lose 2 health.

5. A hose whips across the ground. A sharp spray hits your shell. Lose 3 health.
6. The ground shakes. You slide fast — too fast — and tumble into a pebble trench. Lose 1 health.

The Final Enemy

The compost heap looms. Steam rises from rotting peels and crushed cans. You feel it before you see it:
The Garden Roomba. Modified. Malicious.
It hums — searching for "pests." (Roll 1d6 to face it.)

1–2: It spots you.
A sudden puff of salt-laced air flips you sideways.
You crack your shell on a bottle cap.
Lose 8 health.
3–4: You lunge under a bruised banana.
The Roomba scans, buzzes, spins...
and slides away.
You exhale slime.
+1 to your final roll.
5–6: You ooze around the back —
just in time to see its charging port exposed.
A weak spot. You make a note in slime.
+1 to your final roll.

The grass ahead shimmers with dew.
You're almost free.

Escape or End?

One last ooze. You're cracked, scraped, and salted — but the vegetables glisten in the distance. You push on.
(Roll 1d4 and resolve your final challenge.)

1. A rake falls from the fence! You dart — too slow. Lose 4 health.
2. The sprinkler roars to life. You cling to wet soil as it blasts above. Lose 2 health.
3. The Roomba gives a final beep. It can't reach you... but the salt trail stings your belly. You skid through the edge. Lose 3 health.
4. A shadow passes overhead — he's looking right at you. You freeze beside a stone. Roll d6:
5–6: He moves on.
1–4: A boot hits your shell. Lose 10 health.

If you're still alive...
You've made it.
A dewy kale leaf. A full belly. A patch of sun.
You'll warn the others. You'll remember the fallen.
But for now... you chew.